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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP(Honors) Regular Examination October 2026

MG5DSCHMC300- QUANTITY FOOD PRODUCTION

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Note: Suggested key points are provided for all questions. Each answer is kept brief; equivalent correct answers may also be accepted.

PART A – SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (2 marks each)

1. Any two: religion, culture, climate/geography, income, availability of ingredients, family traditions or lifestyle.

2. Geography and climate determine locally available ingredients, crops, spices and cooking methods, giving each region a distinct cuisine.

3. Any two: gulab jamun, rasgulla, peda, rasmalai, kalakand or palkova.

4. Any two: use of local ingredients; distinctive spices and cooking techniques; influence of climate, culture and tradition.

5. Any two: chapati, naan, parotta, puri, bhatura, roti or appam.

6. Airline catering is the large-scale preparation, packing and supply of meals and beverages for passengers and crew on flights.

7. Any two: nutritional balance, students' preferences, budget, seasonal availability, variety, hygiene or available facilities.

8. Fresh vegetables provide vitamins, minerals and fibre, improve colour and variety, and contribute to a balanced diet.

9. Volume feeding is the preparation and service of food in large quantities to a large number of people, such as in hospitals, hostels or institutions.

10. A theme dinner is a meal planned around a particular concept, culture, region, occasion or period, reflected in its menu and presentation.

11. A purchasing system is the organised procedure for identifying needs, selecting suppliers, ordering, receiving and documenting goods for an establishment.

12. Stainless steel is durable, corrosion-resistant, non-porous, easy to clean and hygienic, making it suitable for food preparation areas.

13. Recipe modification means changing ingredients, quantities or methods to meet nutritional, dietary, cost, availability or portion requirements.

14. Any two: check stock on hand, estimate requirements from the menu and number of portions, verify quality/specifications, and avoid over-ordering.

15. A deep freezer stores food at very low temperatures to preserve it for longer by slowing microbial growth and quality deterioration.

PART B – SHORT ESSAY QUESTIONS (5 marks each)

16. Goan cuisine blends Konkani traditions with Portuguese influence. Rice, fish, seafood, coconut, kokum, tamarind and chillies are common; dishes include fish curry-rice, vindaloo, xacuti and bebinca.

17. North Eastern food culture is diverse and uses rice, vegetables, herbs, bamboo shoots, fermented foods and locally available meat or fish. Many dishes are steamed, boiled, smoked or fermented; examples include Assamese tenga, Naga smoked pork and momos in Sikkim/Arunachal areas.

18. Menu planning controls food cost by matching dishes to the budget, seasonal prices and available stock. Standard recipes, portion control, ingredient utilisation and planned purchasing reduce waste and help maintain the target food-cost percentage.

19. Menu planning aims to provide balanced, appealing and varied meals that meet customer needs and dietary requirements. It also considers budget, seasonality, equipment, staff skills, service style, availability and profitability.

20. Food storage preserves quality and safety, slows spoilage, prevents contamination and pest damage, and reduces waste. It also ensures continuous availability, supports stock rotation and helps control purchasing costs.

21. Advantages: bulk discounts, fewer orders and reduced delivery/administrative costs. Disadvantages: higher initial expenditure, greater storage needs, risk of spoilage or obsolescence, tied-up capital and possible wastage.

PART C – ESSAY QUESTIONS (10 marks each)

22. Indian snacks may be classified as fried, steamed, baked/roasted, savoury, sweet and street-food snacks. Regional examples: samosa and kachori (North); dhokla and fafda (Gujarat); vada pav and misal pav (Maharashtra); idli, medu vada and murukku (South); litti-chokha (Bihar); ghugni and pitha (East); momos (North East). Ingredients and methods reflect local crops, climate and traditions.

23. Hospital menus should follow the doctor's/dietitian's prescription and provide adequate energy, protein, vitamins, minerals and fluids. Consider the patient's diagnosis, age, nutritional status, allergies, culture, religion, appetite and ability to chew or swallow. Examples include low-sodium diets for hypertension, controlled carbohydrates for diabetes, modified textures for dysphagia, soft diets after surgery and therapeutic diets for renal or gastrointestinal conditions. Ensure food safety, attractive presentation, variety, suitable portions and regular monitoring.

24. Kitchen layout planning should ensure a smooth one-way workflow from receiving and storage to preparation, cooking, service and washing. Provide adequate space, safe separation of raw and cooked foods, suitable ventilation, drainage, lighting, water and waste disposal. Select equipment according to production volume, menu, power/fuel supply, ergonomics, cleaning and maintenance needs. Allow safe movement, access for cleaning and repairs, fire safety, staff comfort and future expansion. A well-planned layout improves productivity, hygiene, quality control and cost efficiency.